

PROJECT NAME:**InPlanted**
TEAM MEMBERS: POSTOLACHE IOSIF

IDEA IN SHORT: **InPlanted** is a mobile application designed to help people with no gardening experience, to grow their own edible plants, from agricultural fields and vegetable gardens to apartment rooms and balconies. The app integrates AI technology specialized in guiding users to achieve the best results from their own efforts, encouraging the adoption of a healthy lifestyle and the development of new skills through a naturalist-community approach.

Hardcore Entrepreneur hackathon 5.0

1.PRODUCT - PROBLEM WE SOLVE



InPlanted is not just a simple mobile application, but part of an ideology. We have experienced events that have marked our history in recent years. Starting in 2019, the spread of the now-infamous SARS-CoV-2 virus began, affecting Romania as well. People's first concern was food scarcity, leading them to rush and buy everything they could find on the shelves. At some point, almost everyone must have wondered, "What if I grew my tomatoes?" or "What if I planted an avocado seed?" , most of the time this results in the plant's death before they can enjoy its fruits. Our app is the perfect guide for beginner gardeners. It is designed to help grow certain edible plants, from tomatoes and peppers to highly demanding specimens. The app idea emerged from the need of sustainable development, aiming to contribute to several UN goals. It seeks to equip people with the necessary knowledge to grow and cultivate plants, helping them potentially develop a source of income through vegetable farming. Learning to grow one's food can eventually contribute to a reliable food source. Our community is committed to supporting disadvantaged individuals by offering guidance, aligning with goal 4 of providing quality education that promotes resource management and economic education. This, in turn, supports goal 8, empowering people to utilize the knowledge gained. The app also promotes a healthy lifestyle and partnerships for the goals, is not just about gardening, it is about building a sustainable, educated, and interconnected community.

2. OUR TARGET GROUP & [SDGs](#)



The primary target group represents beginner gardeners aged between 20 and 45 years old, individuals with little to no experience who want to learn how to grow their food but need guidance through the plant grooming process, residents aged between 25 and 50 years old with limited space who wish to exploit small balconies, windowsills, or apartment rooms; people who prioritize healthy, organic, ecological produce. Another target group is represented by educational institutions: schools and community centres that can use InPlanted as an educational tool to teach young people aged between 7-18 years old about sustainable agriculture and environmental stewardship and individuals committed to reducing their carbon footprint, the app encourages ecological practices, including composting and organic gardening. Targeted professions include nutritionists, fitness coaches, teachers, school administrators, small entrepreneurs, and NGO workers interested in supporting a healthy lifestyle and quality-producing education. InPlanted is designed to contribute to some of the United Nations sustainable development goals, including the first goal (No Poverty), the app equips users with the knowledge to reduce grocery expenses, and potentially create income sources through farming activities. Goal nr. 2(Zero Hunger), promoting food self-sufficiency and supporting disadvantaged communities to develop their sources of food and possible income sources; Good Health and Well-Being (third goal), encouraging healthy consumption with ecological produce, contributes to Quality Education (goal 4), Decent Work and Economic Growth (goal 8) and Partnerships for The Goals.

3. SMART OBJECTIVES



Specific: Aim to gain 4,500 active users within the first 6 months of launch by using different forms of powerful marketing channels and advertising
Measurable: Track app downloads and user engagement, aiming for at least 25% user retention after the first 3 months.
Achievable: Form strategic partnerships with micro-influencers and gardening brands to enhance brand visibility and credibility, introduce a referral program to encourage existing users to invite friends and family members, and improve the App Store Optimization techniques to enhance visibility on App Store and Google Play searches, for organic downloads increasing.
Relevant: Expanding the user base aligns with our revenue model by increasing opportunities for in-app purchases, and premium subscriptions.
Time-bound: Within 9 months of launch, aim to increase the percentage of active users engaging in in-app transactions by 15% each quarter, supporting the project's overall growth

4. PRICE



To ensure users have the best experience, InPlanted plans to adopt a freemium model, allowing users to explore application features such as plant identification, watering reminders, access to a basic AI-powered chat, and community chat. This approach aims to attract a broad user base by offering essential functionalities at no cost. For monetization, we will introduce a subscription pro plan that includes monthly and yearly subscription plans. The monthly subscription plan will be priced at \$5.99 per month and includes advanced features like personalized plant care schedules, pest and disease diagnostics powered by the most advanced AI models, and priority customer support. The annual subscription will be offered at \$35.99 per year, equating to approximately \$2.99 per month, providing a 50% discount compared to the monthly plan. This pricing encourages long-term commitment and enhances customer retention. Additionally, the app will offer various premium plans tailored to the needs of different social groups, such as educational institutions and families, enjoying personalized features to ensure the best experience. Furthermore, the application will feature a marketplace where users can purchase exotic plant seeds, which are often hard to find, as well as various practical tools like automatic watering systems. These systems will be directly controlled from the app by the user or through integrated AI functionalities.

5. PROMOTION



Social Media Marketing represents the primary source of promotion for InPlanted, utilizing popular platforms used by both younger and older audiences, such as TikTok, which has demonstrated significant growth in recent years among the population preference. Additionally, Facebook, Instagram, and X serve as very important tools. Sharing and promoting InPlanted's ideas to the masses is much easier to achieve, aiding in the creation of an active community through constant posts, and sharing of content by followers represents an opportunity to surpass the first-year milestone. **Email Marketing:** Develop a premium newsletter to update subscribers on new features, upcoming events, and exclusive promotions, while offering them valuable information on plant grooming and the positive impact that're making with those ecological practices. **App Store Optimization (ASO):** Enhance InPlanted's visibility in app stores by constantly optimizing the app's user interface, title, keywords, and description. A well-executed ASO strategy can improve search rankings and attract more organic downloads. **Influencer Marketing:** Partner with influencers in the gardening field, sustainability, and lifestyle sectors to reach more possible users who will be integrated into our community. **Promotional Offers:** Encourage trial and adoption by offering free premium features for a limited time to new users. Implement a referral program that rewards existing users with additional features or discounts for inviting friends to join the platform. **Content Marketing:** Develop high-quality articles, blogs, and videos that encourage the public on sustainable gardening practices and urban growing edible plants., sharing customer success stories and case studies will build trust and encourage app downloads. **Event Marketing:** Participate in or sponsor environmental fairs, farmers' markets, and sustainability expos, setting up interactive booths for direct engagement with potential users.